

Author's Purpose And Audience

A. Understanding the Author's Purpose

Every writer has a hidden agenda or motivation when they publish a piece of writing. In the UTBK English Literacy subtest, figuring out this motivation is called identifying the Author's Purpose.

- *The Golden Rule*: To find the purpose, look at the Thesis Statement in the introduction and the Call to Action/Conclusion at the end.
- Common Purpose Vocabulary:
 - To inform / To describe: To give neutral facts or explain a natural phenomenon.
 - To criticize / To evaluate: To point out the flaws in a certain habit, policy, or social trend.
 - To persuade / To advocate: To convince the reader to change their behavior or support a cause.

B. Identifying the Target Audience

The Target Audience is the group of people the author had in mind while writing the text. You can easily guess the audience by looking at the complexity of the vocabulary and the tone of the passage:

- General Readers / Public: The text uses simple, easy-to-understand language about daily topics (e.g., healthy eating, sleep habits).
 - Experts / Academics / Specialists: The text uses heavy jargon, complex research metrics, and a highly formal tone (e.g., medical researchers, psychologists, environmentalists).
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C. Worked-Out Example & Detailed Review

Read the following passage carefully:

The modern lifestyle has seen a drastic increase in the consumption of ultra-processed foods, which are heavily engineered with artificial additives, refined sugars, and unhealthy fats. While these

foods are undeniably convenient and intensely marketed, an overwhelming body of nutritional research links them directly to the global rise in chronic metabolic disorders.

Public health advocates argue that relying on individual willpower is no longer enough to combat this epidemic. Governments must step in by implementing strict regulations, such as taxing sugary beverages, enforcing warning labels on unhealthy snacks, and banning junk food advertisements targeted at children. Protecting the long-term health of our society requires immediate, systemic structural changes, not just superficial dietary advice.

Question 1: What is the author's primary purpose in writing the passage?

- A. To describe the chemical engineering process behind ultra-processed foods.
- B. To advocate for government regulations to restrict the consumption of unhealthy foods.
- C. To inform readers about the history of junk food marketing strategies.
- D. To entertain the public with stories about modern dietary habits.
- E. To criticize individuals who lack the willpower to maintain a healthy diet.

- Answer Explanation: Let's look at the second paragraph. The author uses strong phrases like *"Governments must step in"*, *"implementing strict regulations"*, and *"requires immediate, systemic structural changes"*. This is a clear call to action. The author is not just giving neutral information (not A or C); they are actively pushing for a solution. Therefore, the purpose is to advocate for government regulations. Correct Answer: B

Question 2: Who is the most likely target audience for this passage?

- A. Food scientists specializing in chemical additives.
- B. Young children who frequently watch television commercials.
- C. Public policy makers and health conscious citizens.
- D. Historians studying ancient agricultural revolutions.
- E. CEOs of multi-national junk food corporations.

- Answer Explanation: The text discusses public health epidemics and explicitly demands structural changes and government laws (taxes, labels, advertisement bans). This kind of talk is directly aimed at public policy makers (the people who make the laws) and health-conscious citizens who care about social well-being. It is too broad for chemical scientists (A) and too advanced for children (B). Correct Answer: C
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D. Independent Practice Task

Passage for Practice: The psychological phenomenon known as the *Primacy Effect* reveals that humans tend to remember information presented at the very beginning of a sequence much better than information presented later. In social interactions, this cognitive bias forms the bedrock of "first impressions." Within the first few seconds of meeting someone, our brains quickly synthesize visual clues, body language, and tone of voice to create a permanent psychological profile of that person. Because updating this mental profile requires significant cognitive effort, initial impressions usually dictate the entire future dynamic of a relationship.

Question: What is the author's main purpose in the passage above?

- A. To criticize people who make quick judgments about others.
- B. To persuade readers to change their body language during interviews.
- C. To explain the cognitive mechanism and impact of the *Primacy Effect*.
- D. To compare the social behavior of introverts and extroverts.
- E. To entertain readers with funny stories about bad first impressions.